

The Media Story

The person in the ads

AGE _____ PLACE _____

DEVICE _____ MOOD _____

STICK A SCREENSHOT OF THE AD

Your real user

AGE _____ PLACE _____

DEVICE _____ MOOD _____

STICK A PHOTO OR SKETCH, WITH CONSENT

PRODUCT _____

- 1 Spend 15 minutes with real ads and notices.
- 2 Fill both people. Then A–D on yellow cards, numbered by prompt.

PRINT A2 LANDSCAPE · A3 FOR PAIRS
Cards: S1 Evidence

A What it claims

- 1 Its main promise, in its own words
- 2 The word it repeats but never delivers
- 3 A tagline your users would write

B The story it sells

- 1 What it promises to fix but can't
- 2 Where its journey starts and ends
- 3 What its story leaves out

C What the designers meant

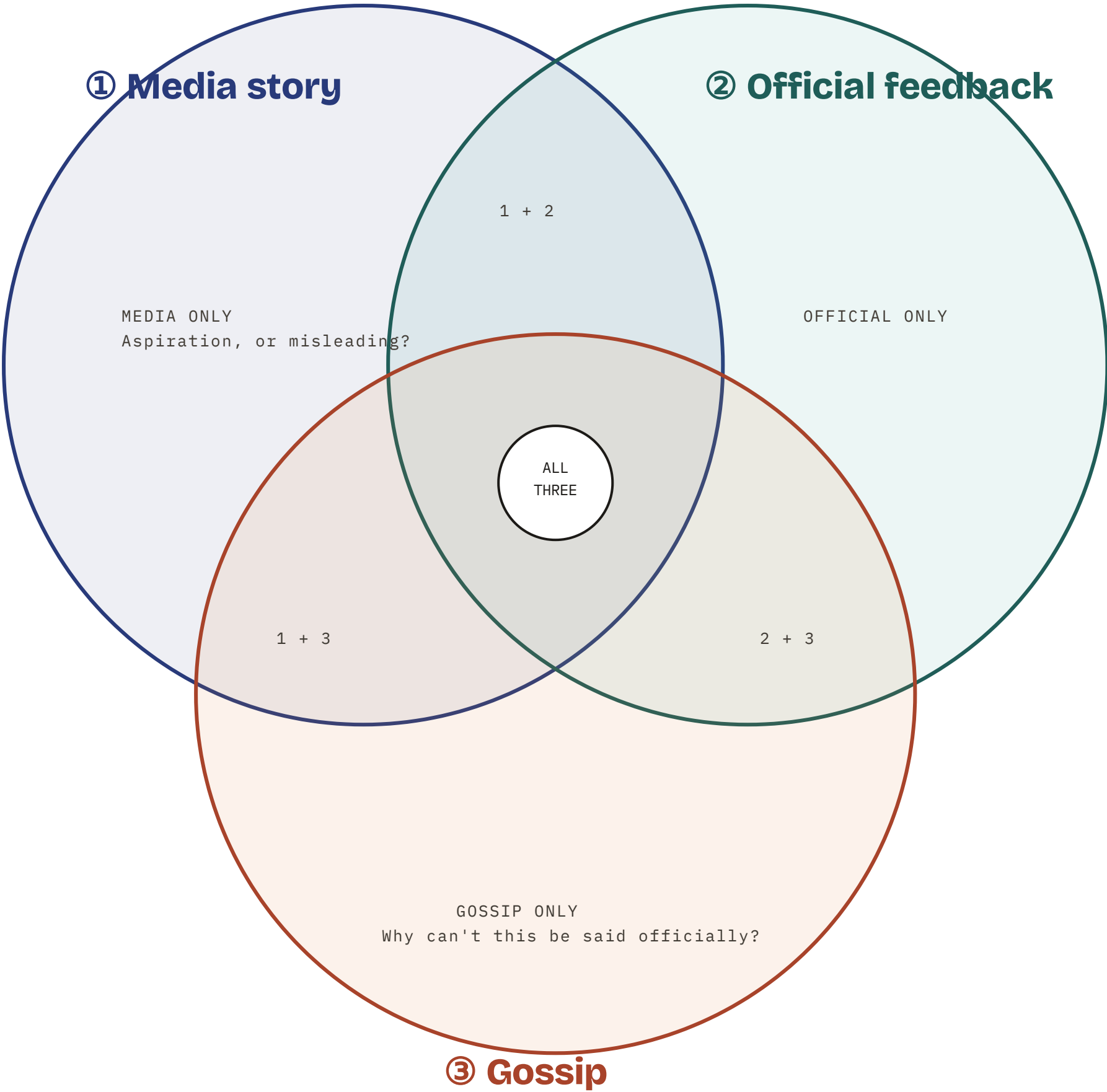
- 1 The problem, in their words
- 2 The user they imagined
- 3 What they designed against, and its cost

D How the user sees it

- 1 A tool, or a gate to get through?
- 2 What they call it
- 3 What they think happens after they submit

The Gossip Venn

PRINT A2 LANDSCAPE · A3 FOR PAIRS
Cards: S1 Evidence · S2 Channels + questions



ASK OF EACH ZONE

Centre. Why hasn't it been fixed? Who gains?

Tone. Which words vanish in official channels?

Folk fixes. What workaround do seniors pass on?

★ HARDEST CONTRADICTION · KEEP FOR SYNTHESIS

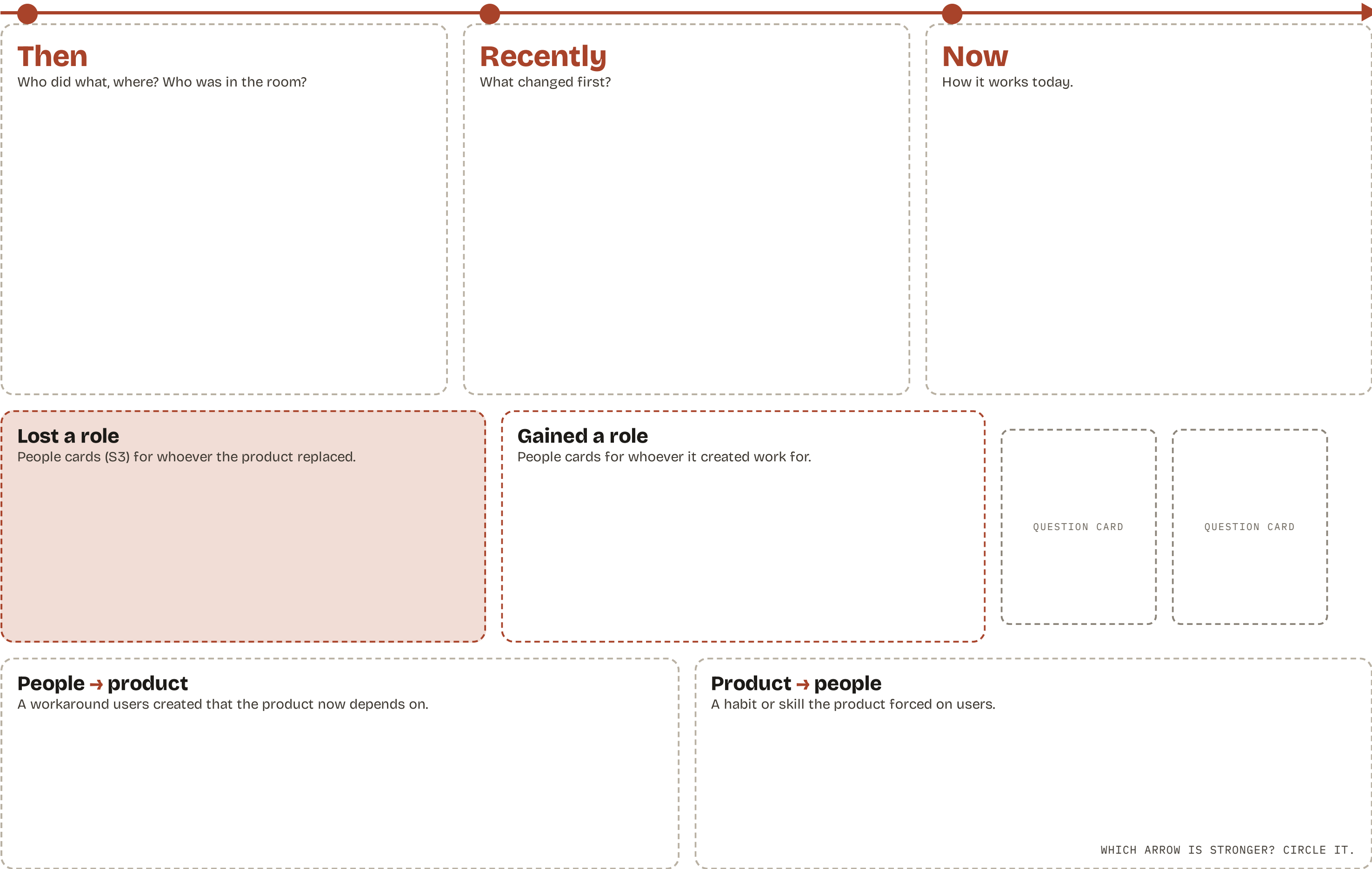
Which two circles clash most?

- 1** Channel cards (S2) go in their circles.
- 2** Quotes on yellow cards, next to their channel.
- 3** Overlaps matter most. Move cards as you argue.
- 4** Question cards: answer on teal notes.

The timeline

- 1
- Talk to someone who did it before it went digital.
- 2
- Notes on the timeline. Move People cards to lost or gained.
- 3
- Put each change on its arrow. Answer the question cards.

PRINT A2 LANDSCAPE · A3 FOR PAIRS
Cards: S1 Evidence · S3 People + questions



Ideal flow + needs

FEATURE _____ GOAL _____

- 1 Steps on orange notes. Then need cards (S4) under each step.
- 2 Fill the dot on every need left for the user to solve.

PRINT A2 LANDSCAPE · A3 FOR PAIRS
Cards: S4 Need cards

	STEP 1	STEP 2	STEP 3	STEP 4	STEP 5	STEP 6
PEOPLE Who must help?						
OBJECTS What must they own?						
SYSTEMS What else must work?						
INFORMATION What must they know?						
WHO THIS WAS DESIGNED FOR · DEVICE, TIME, SKILLS, WHO THEY CAN CALL						
☐ Left to the user: ____ of ____ needs						

Villain walk + Blame Scale

PRINT A2 LANDSCAPE · A3 FOR PAIRS
Cards: S5 Failure, tokens · S6 Constraints

The villain persona

Very unlike the ideal user.

NAME _____

CONTEXT _____

CONSTRAINT CARD ·
S6

- 1 Draw one constraint card for the persona.
- 2 Walk them through each step. Draw the likeliest failure card.
- 3 Write what broke and who pays. Star the likeliest break.
- 4 Take the starred step to the Blame Scale.

QUESTION CARD

QUESTION CARD

STEP _____



FAILURE CARD

WHAT BROKE · WORKAROUND

LIKELY _____ /10

WHO PAYS _____

STEP _____



FAILURE CARD

WHAT BROKE · WORKAROUND

LIKELY _____ /10

WHO PAYS _____

STEP _____



FAILURE CARD

WHAT BROKE · WORKAROUND

LIKELY _____ /10

WHO PAYS _____

STEP _____



FAILURE CARD

WHAT BROKE · WORKAROUND

LIKELY _____ /10

WHO PAYS _____

STEP _____



FAILURE CARD

WHAT BROKE · WORKAROUND

LIKELY _____ /10

WHO PAYS _____

The Blame Scale

Place tokens 1, 2 and ★ (S5) on the line.

STEP _____

Self · “my fault”

System · “its fault”

The gap is the distance between what this product _____ and what it should have _____.

Three lenses + findings

- 1 Choose: this product live, or 2–3 similar ones.
- 2 Read it through each lens card. Answers on teal notes.
- 3 Rate every finding by where you put it.

PRINT A2 LANDSCAPE · A3 FOR PAIRS
Cards: S3 People · S7 Lens + findings

CREATOR LENS CARD

Creator
Who built it, and what did they rush?

AUTHORITY LENS CARD

Authority
What is the institution really guarding against?

POLITICAL LENS CARD

Political
More independent, or more dependent?

Invisible labour
People cards (S3). Tick Seen, Paid and Load-bearing on each.

PEOPLE CARD

PEOPLE CARD

PEOPLE CARD

PEOPLE CARD

PEOPLE CARD

PEOPLE CARD

Findings

Friction users hit

Tensions inside the system

MINOR

MAJOR

CRITICAL

Place each finding card (S7) by how serious it is.

COMPONENT 1 · CARD KIT · BOARD B6

1.39

Synthesis

PRINT A2 LANDSCAPE · A3 FOR PAIRS
Cards: S8 Synthesis · all cards from Tools 1–4

1 · ONE LINE FROM EACH TOOL

MEDIA

GOSSIP

HISTORY

POWER

VILLAIN ★

2 · THE SHARPEST CONTRADICTION

“The product claims _____
, but _____ revealed
_____.”

3 + 4 · THREE REDESIGNS ON THE BLAME SCALE

Place cards A, B, C (S8) on the line. Which one moves the blame furthest toward the system?

Self
It stays the user's problem

System
The product takes the load

5 · POWER TEST

“If this were built, _____ would gain
_____. And _____ would resist it
because _____.”

6 · THE FINDING

“This product assumes _____, but the user
actually has _____, which causes _____
.”

CLAIM CARD

7 · THE DESIGN CLAIM
Fill the claim card last. Every blank must
point to a card already on this board.